



Make Coffee in Space

Lavazza and Argotec get together to make ISSpresso, a system to give the astronauts coffee in space <http://dgit.in/1lVog90>



Water wars begin here

Water sources are depleting which may eventually lead to war. These places are where they might begin. <http://dgit.in/1nrj02S>

Space Age

rug from under them and was awarded the USD 1.6 billion resupply contract to launch 12 missions.

That works out to a cost of about USD 57 million per launch on its Falcon 9 rockets. This may seem like a lot but considering that the average pre-2011 cost quoted by the ULA is about USD 380 million dollars per launch and the 2014 Russian Soyuz charges USD 70 million per trip, its not surprising that NASA chose SpaceX. But its not just about ferrying cargo for SpaceX, that is only the beginning.

SpaceX has done that which very few companies in its industry do – innovate. Instead on relying on outside suppliers for parts, models and designs, SpaceX decided to cut out the middle man and manufacture them in-house. By opting out of the traditional business systems for the aerospace industry, SpaceX effectively turned it on its head.

Being willing to risk his own money and reputation Elon Musk was able to demonstrate that the paradigm could be broken. And as he stepped over its shattered remains he wasn't shy in proclaiming that SpaceX just wasn't a company that would make space launches cheaper for cargo but was ultimately concerned with making human space flight an affordable reality. To do that would be a whole other challenge – to create a human rated spacecraft.

Father of Falcons, Dreamer of Dragons

SpaceX charges USD 5511 per kilogram to transport something to orbit. This remarkably low price even beats out their cheapest international competitors – the



SpaceX's 5.2m fairing – designed in-house by SpaceX – undergoing testing in the world's largest vacuum chamber at NASA Glenn Research Center

Chinese – and leaves big players like the ULA in the dust. The technology behind this well hidden, with no public patents or

any records to hint at their innovation. But it does have a brand name – the Falcon rockets and the Dragon space vehicle.

The Falcon rocket series include the Falcon 1 and the Falcon 9 variants built to sustain a whole new fuel management system, materials use and avionic systems. Within six years of the first prototype testing SpaceX had a successful Falcon 1 test flight in September 2008, becoming the first privately built liquid fuel spacecraft to reach orbit.

While the Falcon 1 was an expendable launch system and was retired after it successfully achieved its first commercial mission of delivering the Malaysian RazakSAT satellite to orbit in September 2009. The sights were now set on the Falcon 9 rocket which was not only human-rated, but also far more powerful and cheaper than any rocket engine in history. Having effectively solved the means



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